



ہائیر ایجوکیشن کمیشن

HIGHER EDUCATION COMMISSION

Government of Pakistan, Islamabad

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Office of the
Director Curriculum
Academics Division

No. HEC/CURR/UGEP/CD/SS/2025/8268

October 27, 2025

SUBJECT: Course Outlines for "Social Sciences" under the General Education Component of the Undergraduate Education Policy (Version 1.1)

The Higher Education Commission (HEC), Islamabad has introduced a two (02) credit hour **mandatory** course titled "Social Sciences" under the General Education component of the Undergraduate Education Policy (Version 1.1). To provide uniform guidance for all Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) regarding the minimum content and related requirements of this course, HEC has developed standardized course outlines for Social Sciences.

02. Please find enclosed the course outlines for information and necessary action towards their adoption by your institution.

SALEEMULLAH SOHOO

Vice Chancellors/Rectors/Heads

All Public/Private Sector Universities/DAIs.

Copy for information to:

1. ES to Chairman, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
2. ES to Executive Director, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
3. PS to Consultant, Quality Assurance, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
4. PS to Managing Director, NAHE, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
5. PS to Advisor, Human Resource Development Division, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
6. PS to Director General, Academics Division, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
7. PS to Director General, A&A Division, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
8. PS to Director General, Higher Education Commission, Regional Centers in Karachi, Lahore, Peshawar & Quetta.
9. Director / In-charge, Higher Education Data Repository, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
10. Director / In-charge, Quality Assurance Agency, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.



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(Curriculum Division)

ENDORSEMENT OF THE COURSE DESIGN COMMITTEE

A meeting of a course design committee was held on **October 20, 2025** in the Higher Education Commission, Islamabad to design a two-credits course of **“Social Sciences”** as part of the general education component of the HEC Undergraduate Education Policy (V 1.1).

Following members of the committee attended the meeting and developed the draft of the course:

1. Dr. Ambreen Fazal, Associate Professor & Chairperson, Department of Media & Communications Studies, Sindh Madressatul Islam University, Karachi.
2. Dr. Bashir Ahmad, Associate Professor & HoD, Department of Public Administration, Government College University, Faisalabad.
3. Dr. Farhan Navid Yousaf, Professor & Director, Institute of Social & Cultural Studies, University of the Punjab, Lahore.
4. Dr. Sadia Saeed, Associate Professor & Director, School of Sociology, Quaid-i-Azam University, Islamabad.
5. Dr. Samina Saeed, Professor & Dean, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, University of Karachi, Karachi.
6. Dr. Sardar Fawad Saleem, Assistant Professor & HoD, Department of Economics, Abbottabad University of Science and Technology, Abbottabad.
7. Dr. Syed Shahid Hussain Bukhari, Professor & Chairman, Department of Political Science, Bahauddin Zakariya University, Multan.
8. Dr. Tauqeer Hussain Shah, Assistant Professor & HoD, Department of Development Studies, National University of Science and Technology, Islamabad.
9. Engr. Saleemullah Sohoo, Director, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
10. Mr. Arif Mahmood, Assistant Director, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.
11. Mr. Qammar Abbas, Assistant Director, Higher Education Commission, Islamabad.

Following members of the committee could not attend the meeting due to official / other commitments:

1. Dr. Anwar Alam, Professor & Dean, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Peshawar, Peshawar.
2. Dr. Iram Khalid, Professor & Dean, Faculty of Behavioral & Social Sciences, University of Punjab, Lahore.
3. Dr. Naveeda Noreen, Assistant Professor / Chairperson, Department of Sociology, University of Management and Technology, Lahore.
4. Dr. Muhammad Taieb, Professor & Chairperson, Department of Social Anthropology, University of Peshawar, Peshawar.

That after consultation and endorsement of the committee, the final draft of course outline is hereby submitted to the office of the Director Curriculum Division, HEC, Islamabad by us / the undersigned on behalf of the committee for consideration of HEC.

Dr. Farhan Navid Yousaf
(Convener)

Dr. Syed Shahid Hussain Bukhari
(Co- Convener)

Mr. Saleemullah Sohoo
(Secretary)

PLEASE NOTE:

1. The Curriculum Division, HEC may conduct an internal review of the draft submitted by the committee and make necessary amendments as and when needed, with or without sharing reasons of the same with the committee.
2. The Curriculum Division, HEC may refer the draft submitted by the committee to other experts or a new committee for review who may propose revisions / additional recommendations in the said draft.

SOCIAL SCIENCES

UGE Policy V 1.1: General Education Course

Credits: 02
Pre-Requisite: Nil
Offering: Undergraduate Degrees (including Associate Degrees)
Placement: 1-4 semesters
Type: General Education
Fields: All

DESCRIPTION

This course provides a basic understanding of human behavior, social relationships, and societies through an interdisciplinary approach of social sciences. It examines the evolution and key concepts of social sciences, including social inquiry, social structure, and social institutions. Moreover, it reflects on social cohesion, inclusivity, and provides an overview of contemporary social problems. The course encourages critical thinking and application of social sciences in the real-world context.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Understand the origin and development of social sciences as a distinct field of study.
2. Analyze human behavior and societies through an interdisciplinary lens of social sciences.
3. Recognize the importance of social cohesion, inclusivity, and social justice.
4. Apply social sciences' concepts to understand and address contemporary social problems.

SYLLABUS

1. **Fundamentals of Social Sciences**
 - Definition and Scope of Social Sciences
 - Evolution of Social Sciences
 - Branches of Social Sciences
2. **Theoretical Perspectives**
 - Structural Functionalism
 - Symbolic Interactionism
 - Conflict Theory
3. **Social Inquiry**
 - Inductive and Deductive Logic
 - Steps in Social Research
 - Ethics in Social Research
4. **Society and Culture**
 - Evolution of Society
 - Types and Components of Culture
 - Social Stratification
5. **Social Cohesion and Inclusivity**
 - Social Justice and Inequalities
 - Role of Minorities in Nation-building
 - Gender and Development
 - Governance, Civic Engagement, and Electoral Process

6. Social Institutions

- Concept of Social Institutions
- Family
- Education
- Religion
- Economy
- State and Government
- Understanding Emerging Social Institutions

7. Social Problems

- Defining Social Problem
- Urbanization, Population and Migration
- Poverty, Inflation, Inequality and Unemployment
- Climate Change and Sustainable Development
- Countering Violent Extremism

SUGGESTED INSTRUCTIONAL / READING MATERIAL

1. "Understanding Social Science" by Michael Martin
2. "Social Science: An Introduction to the Study of Society" by David Colander, Elgin Hunt
3. "Human Development: A Science of Growth" by Justin Pikunas
4. "Sociology: A Down-To-Earth Approach" by James M. Henslin
5. "A History of Political Theory" by George H. Sabine
6. "Psychology: The Science of Mind and Behaviour" by Nigel Holt, et al
7. "Principles of Economics" by Gregory Mankiw
8. "The Art of Being Human: A Textbook for Cultural Anthropology" by Michael Wesch
9. "Pakistan Economic Survey" by Finance Division, Government of Pakistan
10. "Introduction to the Social Sciences" by Zoe Staines, et al
11. "Political Science: Theory and Practice" by Mazhar ul Haq
12. "Understanding Social Problems" by Linda A. Mooney, et al
13. "Media and Society: Power, Platform and Participation" by Nicholas Carah
14. "Introduction to Mass Communication" by Stanly Baran

